DESERONTO POTATO BEANS, ROASTED MUSHROOMS, AND PURSLANE

serves 4 to 6

The Deseronto Potato Bean is a Mohawk heirloom from the Tyendinaga Reservation in Ontario that has a starchy, potato-like texture. You can seek out seeds to grow in your garden or substitute other large white beans in this simple, earthy dish, featuring roasted mushrooms, ramp powder, and the juicy crunch of purslane. You'll need to soak the beans overnight.

- 1 cup dried Deseronto Potato Beans or other large white beans, such as cannellini, soaked overnight and drained
- Sea salt
- 1 pound mixed wild mushrooms, such as chanterelles, sliced ½ inch thick
- 1½ teaspoons Rose Hip Powder (page 359) or store-bought
- 2 tablespoons Ramp Powder (page 110) or 1 tablespoon garlic powder and 1 tablespoon onion powder
- 2 tablespoons cider vinegar
- 1 tablespoon maple syrup
- ¼ cup sunflower oil
- 1 cup fresh purslane, coarsely chopped, for garnish
- 2 tablespoons fresh or dried wild bergamot (bee balm) flowers, for garnish

In a medium pot, combine the soaked beans with water to cover by 2 inches and cook for 45 minutes to 1 hour 15 minutes, until tender. Drain and let cool. Season with salt and let stand so the beans can absorb the seasoning.

Position the rack in the middle of the oven and preheat the oven to 400°F.

Spread the mushrooms over a large baking sheet and roast for about 15 minutes, stirring once halfway through, until wilted and tender. Season well with salt and sprinkle with the rose hip powder.

In a bowl, whisk together the ramp powder, vinegar, syrup, and oil. Fold in the seasoned mushrooms and the cooked beans. Taste and season with salt.

Transfer to a serving bowl, garnish with fresh purslane and wild bergamot flowers, and serve.